Australian Government Fair Work OMBUDSMAN

Pay Guide - Cemetery Industry Award [MA000070]

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When do the rates in the pay guide apply from? The first full pay period starting on or after 11 November 2025.

What is in this pay guide? It's a summary of the award rates. Go to the award for information about coverage, classifications, conditions and the operation of minimum rates, allowances, penalty rates and overtime.

Where can I go for more information? Our Pay and Conditions Tool can help you work out pay rates, leave, notice and redundancy minimum entitlements based on the information you provide. Our website also provides useful templates, best practice guides, fact sheets and online courses.

Disclaimer

The Fair Work Ombudsman is committed to ensuring that information available through this pay guide including data is accurate and incorporates changes to minimum rates of pay, allowances and penalty rates in the award as soon as they come into effect.

However, we cannot guarantee or accept any liability for the accuracy, reliability, currency or completeness of the information available in this pay guide. This is because, for example, there may be a delay between when a change takes effect, and when the information available in the guide is updated.

When considering information available in the pay guide about awards you should also have regard to the terms of the relevant award, which can be found through our Awards page. If our information is inconsistent with the award, then the award applies.

If you need further assistance you can contact us. Alternatively, you may wish to get independent advice from a union, employer association or lawyer on your particular circumstances.

We encourage you to subscribe to email updates to receive alerts when pay rates and entitlements change in this pay guide.

Rates of pay

The rates below include industry allowance.

Note: Trade qualified juniors must be paid the appropriate adult rate.

Adult

Full-time & part-time

Classification	Weekly pay rate	Hourly pay rate	Overtime - Monday to Saturday - first 2 hours	Overtime - Monday to Saturday - after first 2 hours	Overtime - Sunday	Public holiday
Cemetery employee class 1	$963.30	$25.35	$38.03	$50.70	$50.70	$63.38
Cemetery employee class 2	$1,023.00	$26.92	$40.38	$53.84	$53.84	$67.30
Cemetery employee class 3	$1,055.30	$27.77	$41.66	$55.54	$55.54	$69.43
Cemetery employee class 4	$1,109.00	$29.19	$43.79	$58.38	$58.38	$72.98
Cemetery employee class 5	$1,164.80	$30.65	$45.98	$61.30	$61.30	$76.63
Cemetery employee class 6	$1,195.30	$31.46	$47.19	$62.92	$62.92	$78.65

Casual

Classification	Hourly pay rate	Overtime - Monday to Saturday - first 2 hours	Overtime - Monday to Saturday - after first 2 hours	Overtime - Sunday	Public holiday
Cemetery employee class 1	$31.69	$44.36	$57.04	$57.04	$69.71
Cemetery employee class 2	$33.65	$47.11	$60.57	$60.57	$74.03
Cemetery employee class 3	$34.71	$48.60	$62.48	$62.48	$76.37
Cemetery employee class 4	$36.49	$51.08	$65.68	$65.68	$80.27
Cemetery employee class 5	$38.31	$53.64	$68.96	$68.96	$84.29
Cemetery employee class 6	$39.33	$55.06	$70.79	$70.79	$86.52

Junior - Full-time & part-time - Under 17 years

Classification	Weekly pay rate	Hourly pay rate	Overtime - Monday to Saturday - first 2 hours	Overtime - Monday to Saturday - after first 2 hours	Overtime - Sunday	Public holiday
Cemetery employee class 1	$501.95	$13.21	$19.82	$26.42	$26.42	$33.03
Cemetery employee class 2	$531.80	$14.00	$21.00	$28.00	$28.00	$35.00
Cemetery employee class 3	$547.95	$14.42	$21.63	$28.84	$28.84	$36.05
Cemetery employee class 4	$574.80	$15.13	$22.70	$30.26	$30.26	$37.83
Cemetery employee class 5	$602.70	$15.86	$23.79	$31.72	$31.72	$39.65
Cemetery employee class 6	$617.95	$16.26	$24.39	$32.52	$32.52	$40.65

Junior - Full-time & part-time - 17 years

Classification	Weekly pay rate	Hourly pay rate	Overtime - Monday to Saturday - first 2 hours	Overtime - Monday to Saturday - after first 2 hours	Overtime - Sunday	Public holiday
Cemetery employee class 1	$594.22	$15.64	$23.46	$31.28	$31.28	$39.10
Cemetery employee class 2	$630.04	$16.58	$24.87	$33.16	$33.16	$41.45
Cemetery employee class 3	$649.42	$17.09	$25.64	$34.18	$34.18	$42.73
Cemetery employee class 4	$681.64	$17.94	$26.91	$35.88	$35.88	$44.85
Cemetery employee class 5	$715.12	$18.82	$28.23	$37.64	$37.64	$47.05
Cemetery employee class 6	$733.42	$19.30	$28.95	$38.60	$38.60	$48.25

Junior - Full-time & part-time - 18 years

Classification	Weekly pay rate	Hourly pay rate	Overtime - Monday to Saturday - first 2 hours	Overtime - Monday to Saturday - after first 2 hours	Overtime - Sunday	Public holiday
Cemetery employee class 1	$686.49	$18.07	$27.11	$36.14	$36.14	$45.18
Cemetery employee class 2	$728.28	$19.17	$28.76	$38.34	$38.34	$47.93
Cemetery employee class 3	$750.89	$19.76	$29.64	$39.52	$39.52	$49.40
Cemetery employee class 4	$788.48	$20.75	$31.13	$41.50	$41.50	$51.88
Cemetery employee class 5	$827.54	$21.78	$32.67	$43.56	$43.56	$54.45
Cemetery employee class 6	$848.89	$22.34	$33.51	$44.68	$44.68	$55.85

Junior - Full-time & part-time - 19 years

Classification	Weekly pay rate	Hourly pay rate	Overtime - Monday to Saturday - first 2 hours	Overtime - Monday to Saturday - after first 2 hours	Overtime - Sunday	Public holiday
Cemetery employee class 1	$871.03	$22.92	$34.38	$45.84	$45.84	$57.30
Cemetery employee class 2	$924.76	$24.34	$36.51	$48.68	$48.68	$60.85
Cemetery employee class 3	$953.83	$25.10	$37.65	$50.20	$50.20	$62.75
Cemetery employee class 4	$1,002.16	$26.37	$39.56	$52.74	$52.74	$65.93
Cemetery employee class 5	$1,052.38	$27.70	$41.55	$55.40	$55.40	$69.25
Cemetery employee class 6	$1,079.83	$28.42	$42.63	$56.84	$56.84	$71.05

Junior - Casual - Under 17 years

Classification	Hourly pay rate	Overtime - Monday to Saturday - first 2 hours	Overtime - Monday to Saturday - after first 2 hours	Overtime - Sunday	Public holiday
Cemetery employee class 1	$16.51	$23.12	$29.72	$29.72	$36.33
Cemetery employee class 2	$17.50	$24.50	$31.50	$31.50	$38.50
Cemetery employee class 3	$18.03	$25.24	$32.45	$32.45	$39.66
Cemetery employee class 4	$18.91	$26.48	$34.04	$34.04	$41.61
Cemetery employee class 5	$19.83	$27.76	$35.69	$35.69	$43.62
Cemetery employee class 6	$20.33	$28.46	$36.59	$36.59	$44.72

Junior - Casual - 17 years

Classification	Hourly pay rate	Overtime - Monday to Saturday - first 2 hours	Overtime - Monday to Saturday - after first 2 hours	Overtime - Sunday	Public holiday
Cemetery employee class 1	$19.55	$27.37	$35.19	$35.19	$43.01
Cemetery employee class 2	$20.73	$29.02	$37.31	$37.31	$45.60
Cemetery employee class 3	$21.36	$29.91	$38.45	$38.45	$47.00
Cemetery employee class 4	$22.43	$31.40	$40.37	$40.37	$49.34
Cemetery employee class 5	$23.53	$32.94	$42.35	$42.35	$51.76
Cemetery employee class 6	$24.13	$33.78	$43.43	$43.43	$53.08

Junior - Casual - 18 years

Classification	Hourly pay rate	Overtime - Monday to Saturday - first 2 hours	Overtime - Monday to Saturday - after first 2 hours	Overtime - Sunday	Public holiday
Cemetery employee class 1	$22.59	$31.62	$40.66	$40.66	$49.69
Cemetery employee class 2	$23.96	$33.55	$43.13	$43.13	$52.72
Cemetery employee class 3	$24.70	$34.58	$44.46	$44.46	$54.34
Cemetery employee class 4	$25.94	$36.31	$46.69	$46.69	$57.06
Cemetery employee class 5	$27.23	$38.12	$49.01	$49.01	$59.90
Cemetery employee class 6	$27.93	$39.10	$50.27	$50.27	$61.44

Junior - Casual - 19 years

Classification	Hourly pay rate	Overtime - Monday to Saturday - first 2 hours	Overtime - Monday to Saturday - after first 2 hours	Overtime - Sunday	Public holiday
Cemetery employee class 1	$28.65	$40.11	$51.57	$51.57	$63.03
Cemetery employee class 2	$30.43	$42.60	$54.77	$54.77	$66.94
Cemetery employee class 3	$31.38	$43.93	$56.48	$56.48	$69.03
Cemetery employee class 4	$32.96	$46.15	$59.33	$59.33	$72.52
Cemetery employee class 5	$34.63	$48.48	$62.33	$62.33	$76.18
Cemetery employee class 6	$35.53	$49.74	$63.95	$63.95	$78.16

Apprentice - Started before 1 Jan 2014

Classification	Weekly pay rate	Hourly pay rate	Overtime - Monday to Saturday - first 2 hours	Overtime - Monday to Saturday - after first 2 hours	Overtime - Sunday	Public holiday
Apprentice 1st year	$548.09	$14.43	$21.65	$28.86	$28.86	$36.08
Apprentice 2nd year	$681.64	$17.94	$26.91	$35.88	$35.88	$44.85
Apprentice 3rd year	$841.90	$22.16	$33.24	$44.32	$44.32	$55.40
Apprentice 4th year	$1,055.58	$27.78	$41.67	$55.56	$55.56	$69.45

Apprentice - Started after 1 Jan 2014 - Did not complete year 12

Classification	Weekly pay rate	Hourly pay rate	Overtime - Monday to Saturday - first 2 hours	Overtime - Monday to Saturday - after first 2 hours	Overtime - Sunday	Public holiday
Apprentice 1st year	$574.80	$15.13	$22.70	$30.26	$30.26	$37.83
Apprentice 2nd year	$681.64	$17.94	$26.91	$35.88	$35.88	$44.85
Apprentice 3rd year	$841.90	$22.16	$33.24	$44.32	$44.32	$55.40
Apprentice 4th year	$1,055.58	$27.78	$41.67	$55.56	$55.56	$69.45

Apprentice - Started after 1 Jan 2014 - Completed year 12

Classification	Weekly pay rate	Hourly pay rate	Overtime - Monday to Saturday - first 2 hours	Overtime - Monday to Saturday - after first 2 hours	Overtime - Sunday	Public holiday
Apprentice 1st year	$628.22	$16.53	$24.80	$33.06	$33.06	$41.33
Apprentice 2nd year	$735.06	$19.35	$29.03	$38.70	$38.70	$48.38
Apprentice 3rd year	$841.90	$22.16	$33.24	$44.32	$44.32	$55.40
Apprentice 4th year	$1,055.58	$27.78	$41.67	$55.56	$55.56	$69.45

Adult Apprentice - Started before 1 Jan 2014

Classification	Weekly pay rate	Hourly pay rate	Overtime - Monday to Saturday - first 2 hours	Overtime - Monday to Saturday - after first 2 hours	Overtime - Sunday	Public holiday
Apprentice 1st year	$548.09	$14.43	$21.65	$28.86	$28.86	$36.08
Apprentice 2nd year	$681.64	$17.94	$26.91	$35.88	$35.88	$44.85
Apprentice 3rd year	$841.90	$22.16	$33.24	$44.32	$44.32	$55.40
Apprentice 4th year	$1,055.58	$27.78	$41.67	$55.56	$55.56	$69.45

Adult Apprentice - Started after 1 Jan 2014

Classification	Weekly pay rate	Hourly pay rate	Overtime - Monday to Saturday - first 2 hours	Overtime - Monday to Saturday - after first 2 hours	Overtime - Sunday	Public holiday
Apprentice 1st year	$895.32	$23.56	$35.34	$47.12	$47.12	$58.90
Apprentice 2nd year	$963.30	$25.35	$38.03	$50.70	$50.70	$63.38
Apprentice 3rd year	$963.30	$25.35	$38.03	$50.70	$50.70	$63.38
Apprentice 4th year	$1,055.58	$27.78	$41.67	$55.56	$55.56	$69.45

Allowances

If any all purpose allowances apply (marked *), they should be added to the minimum rate before penalties and overtime are calculated.

Allowances	Rate
Apprentice training fees and textbook costs reimbursement	reimbursement of training fees for prescribed courses and the cost of prescribed textbooks
Apprentice travel to block release training reimbursement	reimbursement for the excess reasonable travel costs incurred in the course of travelling to and from the training
Excavation allowance	$57.69 for the first body and $28.85 for each additional body from the same grave
Exhumation allowance - body has been buried for 14 days or less	$95.09 per body
Exhumation allowance - body has been buried for more than 14 days but less than seven years - arterially embalmed and sealed in a metal, polythene or plastic container	$114.32 per body
Exhumation allowance - body has been buried for more than 14 days but less than seven years - has not been arterially embalmed and inserted in a metal, polythene or plastic container	$190.18 per body
Exhumation allowance - body has been buried in excess of seven years	$95.09 per body
First aid allowance	$12.82 per week
* Industry allowance (already included in the rate tables above)	$1.07 per hour
Leading hand in charge of 2 to 6 employees (not Class 5 or above)	$22.44 per week
Leading hand in charge of more than 6 employees (not Class 5 or above)	$49.15 per week
Lift and deepen allowance - 5 years but less than 10 years since last burial	$92.95 per procedure
Lift and deepen allowance - 10 years but less than 25 years since last burial	$69.45 per procedure
Lift and deepen allowance - 25 years but less than 50 years since last burial	$45.94 per procedure
Lift and deepen allowance - more than 50 years since last burial	$23.50 per procedure
Meal allowance - overtime	$16.27
Vehicle allowance	$0.99 per km